

Track Naming Grammar Specification

Demo(N)Tapes

This section consolidates the grammar rules implicit in the seven lexicon passes. It governs how selected semantic positions become a title. It does not determine the track's authoritative composition or alter its tags, aspects, pair structure, or mechanical degrees.

1. Grammar notation

The templates use the following lexical categories:

Symbol	Lexical category	Example
M	Surface modifier	<i>glacial, consecrated, primitive</i>
N	Head noun	<i>silence, burial, vengeance</i>
V	Dominant action, normally a gerund	<i>burying, defiling, embracing</i>
O	Object, person, body, or state	<i>the sacred face, the wounded one</i>
L	Location or spatial object	<i>the altar, the empty house</i>
A	Abstraction, doctrine, emotion, or concept	<i>devotion, purpose, nothingness</i>
E	Event or temporal object	<i>the final blessing, the first breath</i>
C	Condition or contextual phrase	<i>after the final word, beneath an empty sky</i>
R	Result or consequence phrase	<i>left unanswered, reduced to nothing</i>
I	Instrument or material	<i>the sharpened blade, spit, rusted wire</i>

A lexical entry may be eligible for more than one category, but eligibility must be authored explicitly. The generator must not assume that every noun can function as an object, location, abstraction, or event.

2. Fundamental grammar rules

2.1 Semantic positions are not single words

One semantic position may produce a phrase containing several words.

For example, a Sacred submissive position may produce:

the Sacred Face

This remains one semantic position even though it contains an article, adjective, and noun.

The three-position limit therefore means a maximum of three represented **tag occurrences**, not three words.

2.2 Source roles remain distinct

Each represented position retains its source role:

- solitary;
- pair-dominant;
- pair-submissive.

Identical tag identities are not merged when their roles differ.

Example:

(Profane₂ + Sacred₁) + Sacred₂

may produce:

Consecrated Spit on the Sacred Face

The solitary Sacred occurrence produces **Consecrated**. The paired Sacred occurrence produces **the Sacred Face**.

2.3 A formal pair establishes grammatical direction

In a tag-pair:

(Dominant + Submissive)

the dominant position governs the relationship. It normally supplies:

- the action;
- the governing noun;
- the consequence;
- or the principal modifier.

The submissive position normally supplies:

- the target;
- the object;
- the location;
- the affected abstraction;
- or the condition against which the dominant force acts.

Reversing the pair reverses the grammatical relationship.

(Profane + Sacred) may produce **Defiling the Altar**.

(Sacred + Profane) may produce **Consecrating the Gutter**.

These are not interchangeable titles.

2.4 Opposing solitary tags do not automatically form a pair

Two solitary anti-tags remain accumulative unless the composition explicitly identifies them as a formal pair.

Therefore:

Profane + Sacred

must not automatically use the same grammar as:

(Profane + Sacred)

The first may produce an accumulative title such as:

Unholy Reverence

The second may produce a directed contradiction such as:

Spitting on the Sacred Face

2.5 Solitary tags use accumulative grammar

When no formal pair is represented, the selected tags are combined through:

- modification;
- association;
- setting;
- action and object;
- object and consequence;
- or head noun and contextual phrase.

They do not imply domination, submission, attack, conversion, destruction, or protection unless the chosen lexical items themselves express such an action.

2.6 A pair remains the grammatical core

When a title contains a represented pair and one additional tag, the pair supplies the core clause or noun phrase.

The additional position normally supplies:

- an initial surface modifier;

- a contextual phrase;
- or, less commonly, a final consequence.

Default form:

[Surface modifier] + [Pair construction]

Example:

(Cold₂ + Warm₁) + Warm₂

becomes:

Embracing Silence at the Welcoming Door

The pair produces **Silence at the Welcoming Door**. The solitary tag produces **Embracing**.

2.7 Grammar never mutates semantics

A tag may be grammatically realized as a modifier, noun, action, object, or setting without changing its source role or mechanical meaning.

The generated title is an interpretation of the selected positions, not a transformed semantic object.

3. General template families

3.1 One solitary tag

A single tag may use any of the following forms.

Modifier and head noun

[M₁] [N₁]

Examples:

- **Uneven Grit**
- **Masterful Command**
- **Hollow Absence**

Head noun and context

[N₁] [C₁]

Examples:

- **Sorrow beneath the Funeral Bell**
- **Guardianship before the Blow Can Fall**
- **Purpose beneath the Guiding Star**

Action and object

[V₁] [O₁]

Examples:

- **Rejecting the Shrine**
- **Awakening the Dead**
- **Withholding the Offered Hand**

This form is valid only when the tag's own lexicon contains a coherent internal target.

Head noun and internal abstraction

[N₁] of [A₁]

Examples:

- **Burden of Years**
- **Revelation of Purpose**
- **Extinction of Hope**

Object and consequence

[O₁] [R₁]

Examples:

- **The Forgotten Name Erased**
- **The Wounded One Carried to Safety**
- **The Final Breath Sealed beneath Stone**

3.2 Two solitary tags

One position becomes the grammatical governor and the other becomes its support.

The governor normally supplies the noun, action, or consequence. The supporting position supplies the modifier, object, abstraction, or context.

Supporting modifier and governing noun

[M₂] [N₁]

Examples:

- **Bitter Obscenity**
- **Open Violation**
- **Dedicated Stasis**

Governing noun and supporting context

[N₁] [C₂]

Examples:

- **Extinction after Every Answer Has Failed**
- **Control where No Step Can Settle**
- **Permafrost where Every Voice Is Answered**

Governing action and supporting object

[V₁] [O₂]

Examples:

- **Burying the Beating Heart**
- **Naming the Abyss**
- **Forgiving the Vengeful**

This construction does not create a formal pair. It is a textual association between two solitary meanings.

Supporting object and governing consequence

[O₂] [R₁]

Examples:

- **The Living Hand Sealed beneath Stone**
- **The Empty Page Made Significant**
- **The Breathless Messenger Ground Down by Duration**

Governing noun of supporting abstraction

[N₁] of [A₂]

Examples:

- **Vow of Damnation**
- **Silence of Kinship**
- **Geometry of Decay**

Modifier collision form

[M₁] [N₂]

This is allowed only when the two expressions produce a meaningful compound.

Examples:

- **Primitive Precision**
- **Bleak Devotion**
- **Exuberant Decay**

A compound must be rejected when it becomes merely redundant or nonsensical.

3.3 Three solitary tags

Three-tag titles normally contain:

1. a surface modifier;
2. a governing noun or action;
3. an object, context, abstraction, or consequence.

Modifier, head noun, context

[M₃] [N₁] [C₂]

Examples:

- **Remote Consecration after the Insult**
- **Resilient Passage during Consecration**
- **Merciful Abundance beneath the Accusing Eye**

Modifier, action noun, object

[M₃] [N₁] against/within/upon [O₂]

Examples:

- **Protective Vengeance against the Generous Hand**
- **Desolate Incision against All Remaining Structure**
- **Divine Firestorm upon the Waiting Hour**

Modifier, action, object

[M₃] [V₁] [O₂]

Example structure:

- **Fervent Naming of the Abyss**
- **Glacial Withholding of the Open Hand**

Modifier, head noun, abstraction

[M₃] [N₁] of [A₂]

Examples:

- **Sacrilegious Extinction of Hope**
- **Primitive Geometry of Devotion**

Object, consequence, context

[O₂] [R₁] [C₃]

Example structure:

- **The Living Heart Sealed beneath Stone after the Final Word**

This longer form should be weighted less heavily because it tends to produce cumbersome titles.

4. Pair grammar

A pair title must represent the dominant position as acting upon, transforming, opposing, containing, or defining the submissive position.

4.1 Dominant action and submissive object

[V_D] [O_S]

Examples:

- **Defiling the Altar**
- **Embracing the Distant Figure**

- **Dissecting the Animal Noise**
- **Arresting the Racing Heart**

4.2 Dominant noun and submissive location

[N_D] within/at/beneath/through/upon [L_S]

Examples:

- **Purpose within the Lightless Chamber**
- **Silence at the Shared Table**
- **Decay within the Bloodstream**
- **Weight upon the Burning Track**

The preposition must be selected from those licensed for the axis and lexical entries.

4.3 Submissive object and dominant consequence

[O_S] [R_D]

Examples:

- **The Offered Mercy Repaid in Blood**
- **The Living Hand Sealed beneath Stone**
- **The Empty Page Left without Meaning**
- **The Broken Signal Cut to Measure**

This form places the submissive position first grammatically, but the dominant tag still governs the transformation.

4.4 Dominant modifier and submissive head noun

[M_D] [N_S]

Examples:

- **Primitive Precision**
- **Bleak Devotion**
- **Monolithic Urgency**
- **Vindictive Kindness**

This is the most compressed pair construction. It should be used less often because the direction of the pair is less explicit.

4.5 Dominant noun of submissive abstraction

[N_D] of [A_S]

Examples:

- **Desecration of the Final Liturgy**
- **Extinction of Purpose**
- **Vengeance of Mercy**

This form is valid only where the genitive relation remains legible.

4.6 Dominant event before or after submissive condition

[E_D] before/after [C_S]

or:

[C_D] before/after [E_S]

Examples:

- **Oblivion after Revelation**
- **Frost after the Embrace**
- **Cruelty before Forgiveness**

4.7 Dominant instrument against submissive structure

[I_D] against/through/upon [O_S]

Examples:

- **The Surgeon's Knife against the Primitive Pulse**
- **Excrement upon the Consecrated Altar**
- **The Iron Gate against the Stampede**

This template is axis-dependent and must not be used unless the dominant lexicon supplies a valid instrument or material.

5. Pair plus surface tag

The default structure is:

[M_F] + [Pair core]

where F is the additional surface position.

Examples:

(Raw₂ + Honed₁) + Honed₂

Precise Rupture of the Refined Form

(Warm₂ + Cold₁) + Cold₃

Glacial Embrace of the Distant Figure

The surface position may instead provide a context:

[Pair core] [C_F]

Example structure:

Burying the Beating Heart beneath the Returning Sun

A surface consequence is also possible:

[Pair core], [R_F]

This comma construction should be rare and may be omitted from the initial implementation.

The surface tag must not replace either member of the pair. The pair must remain grammatically recoverable.

6. Pair plus two solitary tags

Only one solitary tag is normally lexicalized alongside the pair.

The second solitary tag becomes unrepresented naming overflow and may reinforce a represented position.

Projection:

(Dominant + Submissive) + Solitary A + Solitary B

becomes:

[Pair core] + [strongest eligible surface position]

The unselected solitary tag must not be silently inserted as a fourth semantic position.

7. Two pairs

A four-position composition cannot be represented completely under the three-position limit.

Default projection:

1. Select one pair as the grammatical core.
2. Use the dominant occurrence of the secondary pair as the optional surface position.
3. Leave the secondary pair's submissive occurrence unrepresented.
4. Preserve both pairs in the authoritative composition.

Structure:

(D₁ + S₁) + (D₂ + S₂)

becomes:

[M_D₂] + [Pair core D₁→S₁]

Example:

(Fast₃ + Slow₀) + (Sacred₃ + Profane₀)

may become:

Divine Firestorm upon the Waiting Hour

The title does not imply that Sacred is solitary in the authoritative composition. It is merely being used as the third lexicalized position.

Where the secondary dominant cannot supply a coherent surface modifier, omit it and use only the primary pair.

8. Axis-specific pair grammar

8.1 Profane dominant -> Sacred submissive

- [Profane V] [Sacred O]
- [Profane I] upon [Sacred O]
- [Profane V] during [Sacred E]
- [Sacred O] [Profane R]
- [Profane N] of [Sacred A]
- [Profane N] beneath [Sacred L]

Examples:

- **Spitting on the Sacred Face**
- **Excrement upon the Consecrated Altar**
- **Desecration of the Final Liturgy**
- **The Divine Image Rendered Unholy**

8.2 Sacred dominant -> Profane submissive

- [Sacred V] [Profane O]
- [Sacred N] within [Profane L]
- [Profane O] [Sacred R]
- [Sacred M] [Profane N]

Examples:

- **Consecrating the Gutter**
- **Prayer within the Filth**
- **The Blasphemer Made Holy**
- **Devout Obscenity**

8.3 Cold dominant -> Warm submissive

- [Cold V] [Warm O]
- [Cold N] at [Warm L]
- [Warm O] [Cold R]
- [Cold M] [Warm N]
- [Cold C] after [Warm E]

Examples:

- **Withholding the Offered Hand**
- **Silence at the Shared Table**
- **The Familiar Voice Left Unanswered**
- **Frost after the Embrace**

8.4 Warm dominant -> Cold submissive

- [Warm V] [Cold O]
- [Warm N] within [Cold L]
- [Cold O] [Warm R]
- [Warm M] [Cold N]
- [Warm E] beyond [Cold C]

Examples:

- **Embracing the Distant Figure**
- **Kinship within the Empty House**
- **The Stranger Drawn Near**
- **Affection beyond the Final Silence**

8.5 Raw dominant -> Honed submissive

- [Raw V] [Honed O]
- [Raw N] through [Honed structure]
- [Honed O] [Raw R]
- [Raw M] [Honed N]
- [Raw C] beneath [Honed control]

Examples:

- **Shattering the Measured Form**
- **Feedback through the Perfected Sequence**
- **The Tempered Blade Dragged through Distortion**
- **Primitive Precision**

8.6 Honed dominant -> Raw submissive

- [Honed V] [Raw O]
- [Honed N] within [Raw C]
- [Raw O] [Honed R]
- [Honed M] [Raw N]
- [Honed I] against [Raw structure]

Examples:

- **Dissecting the Animal Noise**
- **Precision within the Feedback**
- **The Broken Signal Cut to Measure**
- **The Surgeon's Knife against the Primitive Pulse**

8.7 Fast dominant -> Slow submissive

- [Fast V] [Slow O]
- [Fast N] through [Slow C]
- [Slow O] [Fast R]
- [Fast M] [Slow N]
- [Fast E] before [Slow C]

Examples:

- **Outrunning the Funeral Procession**
- **Frenzy through the Unending Night**
- **The Iron March Scattered in Passage**
- **Blistering Patience**

8.8 Slow dominant -> Fast submissive

- [Slow V] [Fast O]
- [Slow N] upon [Fast path]
- [Fast O] [Slow R]
- [Slow M] [Fast N]
- [Slow O] against [Fast E]

Examples:

- **Arresting the Racing Heart**
- **Weight upon the Burning Track**
- **The Breathless Messenger Ground Down by Duration**
- **The Iron Gate against the Stampede**

8.9 Malevolent dominant -> Benevolent submissive

- [Malevolent V] [Benevolent O]
- [Malevolent N] against [Benevolent institution or condition]
- [Benevolent O] [Malevolent R]
- [Malevolent M] [Benevolent N]
- [Malevolent E] before [Benevolent consequence]

Examples:

- **Poisoning the Open Hand**
- **Vengeance against the Place of Refuge**
- **The Offered Mercy Repaid in Blood**
- **Vindictive Kindness**

8.10 Benevolent dominant -> Malevolent submissive

- [Benevolent V] [Malevolent O]
- [Benevolent N] within [Malevolent C]
- [Malevolent O] [Benevolent R]
- [Benevolent M] [Malevolent N]

- [Benevolent O] before [Malevolent E]

Examples:

- **Forgiving the Vengeful**
- **Mercy within the Blood-Debt**
- **The Poisoned Hand Carried to Safety**
- **Shelter before the Settling of Debts**

8.11 Morbid dominant -> Vital submissive

- [Morbid V] [Vital O]
- [Morbid N] within [Vital L]
- [Vital O] [Morbid R]
- [Morbid M] [Vital N]
- [Morbid C] after [Vital E]

Examples:

- **Burying the Beating Heart**
- **Decay within the Bloodstream**
- **The Living Hand Sealed beneath Stone**
- **Funereal Vitality**

8.12 Vital dominant -> Morbid submissive

- [Vital V] [Morbid O]
- [Vital N] within [Morbid L]
- [Morbid O] [Vital R]
- [Vital M] [Morbid N]
- [Vital growth] through [Morbid C]

Examples:

- **Awakening the Unnamed Dead**
- **Growth within the Charnel House**
- **The Sealed Crypt Overgrown with Life**
- **Roots through the Funeral Cloth**

8.13 Void dominant -> Meaning submissive

- [Void V] [Meaning O or A]
- [Void N] beneath [Meaning sign or L]
- [Meaning O] [Void R]
- [Void M] [Meaning N]
- [Void C] after [Meaning E]

Examples:

- **Erasing the Chosen Name**
- **Nothingness beneath the Guiding Star**
- **The Sworn Oath Reduced to Nothing**
- **Oblivion after Revelation**

8.14 Meaning dominant -> Void submissive

- [Meaning V] [Void O or C]
- [Meaning N] within [Void L]
- [Void O] [Meaning R]
- [Meaning M] [Void N]
- [Meaning sign] beyond [Void C]

Examples:

- **Naming the Abyss**
- **Purpose within the Lightless Chamber**
- **The Empty Page Made Significant**
- **The Guiding Star beyond Final Doubt**

9. Degree rules

9.1 Degree governs vocabulary intensity

The naming-effective degree determines which lexical band is available.

- Degree 0: mild, incidental, ordinary, incomplete.
- Degree 1: clear and recognizable.
- Degree 2: forceful, established, severe.
- Degree 3: absolute, terminal, transcendent, catastrophic, or maximal.

Grammar structure does not itself raise degree.

A degree-0 position must not select a degree-3 lexical item merely because that item fits the sentence better.

9.2 Reinforced degree affects only lexical selection

Overflow reinforcement may raise a selected position's naming-effective degree up to 3.

It does not change:

- the source tag's degree;
- the track's composition;
- pair roles;
- later TRVE evaluation.

9.3 Backoff is downward only

When no grammatically valid entry exists at the exact effective degree:

1. attempt another entry at the same degree;
2. attempt another eligible template;
3. back off to the next lower lexical degree;
4. continue until a valid title is found.

The generator must not select vocabulary from a higher degree than the effective degree.

10. Article rules

Lexical entries should be normalized rather than storing inconsistent visible articles.

Each noun phrase should specify an article mode:

- None: *spit, frost, devotion*;
- Definite: *the altar, the broken signal*;
- Indefinite: *a vacant throne*;
- Fixed: phrase already contains its required determiner;
- Proper: no article permitted.

A template must not insert an article when the lexical entry already includes one.

Invalid:

the the altar

Valid:

the altar

Mass nouns and abstractions normally use no article:

- *decay*;
- *silence*;
- *vengeance*;
- *nothingness*.

11. Preposition rules

Prepositions belong primarily to templates, not lexical entries.

Preferred relational prepositions include:

- against - explicit opposition;
- upon - impact, burden, or imposition;
- within - containment or internal contradiction;
- through - traversal or penetration;
- beneath - hierarchy, burial, concealment, or pressure;
- before - anticipation, judgment, or temporal precedence;
- after - consequence or aftermath;
- beyond - transcendence, distance, or terminal separation;
- of - possession, abstraction, or semantic relation;

- during - ritual or event context;
- at - specific location or encounter.

A contextual fragment that already contains a preposition is a complete C phrase and must not receive another preposition.

Invalid:

within beneath an empty sky

Valid:

beneath an empty sky

12. Morphological rules

12.1 Actions

Dominant actions normally use the gerund:

- *Spitting*;
- *Burying*;
- *Naming*;
- *Embracing*.

A nominalized action may be used when the template requires a head noun:

- *Desecration*;
- *Burial*;
- *Vengeance*;
- *Revelation*.

The generator must not mechanically convert arbitrary verbs into nouns. Both forms should exist as authored lexical entries.

12.2 Consequences

Consequences normally use past-participial or result constructions:

- *left unanswered*;
- *repaid in blood*;
- *reduced to nothing*;
- *carried to safety*;
- *sealed beneath stone*.

They follow the affected object:

[Affected object] [Consequence]

12.3 Modifiers

Modifiers must agree semantically with the noun they modify.

They do not require grammatical gender or number agreement in English, but singular/plural phrase compatibility must still be respected.

Awkward:

a monolithic voices

Valid:

monolithic voices

a monolithic voice

13. Repetition and collision rules

13.1 Exact word repetition

A title must reject repeated content words unless repetition is deliberately authored.

Invalid:

- **Hateful Hatred**
- **Empty Emptiness**
- **Devoted Devotion**
- **Frozen Frost**

13.2 Lexical-family repetition

Entries should carry a lexical-family identifier so related forms can be detected.

For example:

- hate
- hateful
- hatred

belong to the same family.

A template should normally use only one member of a lexical family.

13.3 Functional-word repetition

Repeated prepositions or articles must be rejected.

Invalid:

- **within the within the tomb**
- **of the of the sacred face**

13.4 Duplicate semantic phrases

Two distinct semantic positions may share the same tag identity, but they should not produce identical visible phrases.

Example source:

(Sacred₁ + Profane₁) + Sacred₁

Valid:

Devout Blessing of the Defiant Tongue

Weak:

Sacred Sacredness of the Sacred

The semantic duplication remains, but the lexical realization should distinguish the roles.

14. Semantic-legibility rules

A title must be rejected when:

- the pair direction becomes reversed;
- the submissive position appears to dominate the dominant one;
- opposing solitary tags are falsely presented as a formal pair;
- a result phrase has no affected object;
- an action has no valid target;
- a preposition creates an impossible relation;
- the title introduces a semantic category absent from all selected tags;
- the title requires four represented positions;
- the title is grammatically valid but semantically unreadable.

The generator should choose a simpler valid template rather than preserve a complicated but incoherent one.

15. Length rules

Preferred title length:

- 2-5 words for solitary titles;
- 3-7 words for two-position titles;
- 4-9 words for pair or three-position titles.

Soft maximum:

12 words

Longer contextual constructions may exist in the lexicon, but the generator should prefer compact alternatives.

Articles and short prepositions count toward visible length but should not affect semantic-position count.

16. Capitalization and punctuation

Titles use English title case.

Capitalize:

- nouns;
- verbs;
- adjectives;
- adverbs;
- first and final words.

Normally lowercase:

- articles;
- short conjunctions;
- short prepositions.

Examples:

- **Spitting on the Sacred Face**
- **Purpose within the Lightless Chamber**
- **Frost after the Embrace**

Titles normally have no terminal punctuation.

Colons, semicolons, quotation marks, parentheses, and exclamation marks are not part of the initial grammar set.

17. Deterministic template selection

Given the same:

- ordered semantic composition;
- pair structure;
- naming-effective degrees;
- lexicon version;
- and naming seed;

the generator must select the same:

- naming projection;
- grammar family;
- template;
- lexical entries;
- prepositions;
- and final title.

Random selection must therefore use a deterministic seeded source rather than runtime-global randomness.

18. Fallback sequence

When title construction fails, use this order:

1. Selected pair plus surface modifier.
2. Selected pair without surface modifier.
3. Pair action and object.
4. Pair modifier and head noun.
5. Two-tag accumulative modifier and noun.
6. Single governing tag modifier and noun.
7. Single governing tag head noun.
8. Neutral placeholder derived from track identity.

The fallback must never discard or alter the authoritative semantic composition.